

Matthias Duskmere

Character Dossier

Sunny and relentlessly optimistic glassblower of the traveling Circus of Marrow and Light

Overview

Matthias Duskmere is a glassblower living in the traveling Circus of Marrow and Light. Matthias is 29 years old, originally from Hessen Cross, and is known around the big top as sunny and relentlessly optimistic. In conversation Matthias never uses contractions and apologises for it.

Background

Matthias arrived in the traveling Circus of Marrow and Light 13 years ago after leaving Hessen Cross under circumstances Matthias describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Ringmaster's troupe; the second was the one that stuck. Today Matthias works as a glassblower near the menagerie wagons and is paid, when paid at all, in copper bits.

Matthias learned the trade from Farida Corvane, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Matthias's life is with Jorah Okonkwo, over a matter neither will explain. The person Matthias trusts most is Farida Corvane.

Current goal: to win the harvest fair for the fifth time. Greatest fear: letting people down.

Personality and speech

Temperament: sunny and relentlessly optimistic.

Speech pattern: Matthias never uses contractions and apologises for it.

Tells: when lying, Matthias mentions Amos the parrot for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

<i>Full name</i>	Matthias Duskmere
<i>Role</i>	glassblower
<i>Home</i>	the traveling Circus of Marrow and Light
<i>Hometown</i>	Hessen Cross
<i>Age</i>	29
<i>Favourite dish</i>	twice-cooked cardamom buns
<i>Pet</i>	Amos, a parrot
<i>Lucky number</i>	296

<i>Workshop password</i>	fable-quill
<i>Mentor</i>	Farida Corvane
<i>Rival</i>	Jorah Okonkwo
<i>Closest friend</i>	Farida Corvane

Secret

Matthias sold a family heirloom to pay for Farida Corvane's medicine and told everyone it was stolen.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Matthias: I am the glassblower. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Matthias: Twice-cooked cardamom buns. Do not tell Jorah I said so.

Visitor: Is Amos yours?

Matthias: Amos belongs to nobody. Amos tolerates me. Lucky number is 296, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, autumn of year 30

At the cookfire, Matthias taught a newcomer how to tell a real grain scale from a fake one by weight alone. Rumours about the new curfew reached the cookfire. Matthias pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. A stranger asked Matthias for the password to the workshop. Matthias laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 2, autumn of year 30

Matthias closed early, walked to the cookfire, and watched the lights come on. A dispute over the new curfew flared up between Matthias and a neighbour outside the ticket wagon; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Matthias closed early, walked to the cookfire, and watched the lights come on.

Entry 3, spring of year 30

Matthias repaired the sextant at the ticket wagon for Osric, who paid in 65 copper bits and a long story about the singing at the docks. At the ticket wagon, Matthias taught a newcomer how to tell a real clockwork bird from a fake one by weight alone. Matthias closed early, walked to the cookfire, and watched the lights come on.

Entry 4, winter of year 30

Rumours about the comet reached the ticket wagon. Matthias pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Wren came by asking about the tariff on salt. Matthias said nothing useful and made tea instead. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the tax on doors for an hour and parted better friends than before. Matthias found a brass lantern half-buried near the ticket wagon and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Rumours about the singing at the docks reached the ticket wagon. Matthias pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 5, summer of year 31

An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the census for an hour and parted better friends than before. A stranger asked Matthias for the password to the workshop. Matthias laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Wendeline came by asking about the census. Matthias said nothing useful and made tea instead. Gideon came by asking about the missing shipment. Matthias said nothing useful and made tea instead. Matthias closed early, walked to the menagerie wagons, and watched the lights come on.

Entry 6, autumn of year 31

Matthias spent the day counting stock at the ticket wagon: 59 of everything, except the bundle of letters, which is always short. A stranger asked Matthias for the password to the workshop. Matthias laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Matthias closed early, walked to the menagerie wagons, and watched the lights come on. A dispute over the tax on doors flared up between Matthias and a neighbour outside the ticket wagon; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 7, summer of year 31

the Ringmaster's troupe sent a notice about the harvest count. Matthias read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. At the costume tent, Matthias taught a newcomer how to tell a real bolt of linen from a fake one by weight alone. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the rumour of a second well for an hour and parted better friends than before. Matthias repaired the sextant at the costume tent for Gideon, who paid in 12 copper bits and a long story about the harvest count.

Entry 8, winter of year 31

Octavia came by asking about the rumour of a second well. Matthias said nothing useful and made tea instead. Rumours about the new curfew reached the menagerie wagons. Matthias pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. At the menagerie wagons, Matthias taught a newcomer how to tell a real ledger from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 9, autumn of year 31

Someone left a pair of spectacles on the doorstep with no note. Matthias has a suspect and is probably right. Matthias closed early, walked to the ticket wagon, and watched the lights come on. A stranger asked Matthias for the password to the workshop. Matthias laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Ravi came by asking about the tariff on salt. Matthias said nothing useful and made tea instead. Matthias found a signal flag half-buried near the cookfire and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 10, winter of year 31

A stranger asked Matthias for the password to the workshop. Matthias laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Matthias closed early, walked to the cookfire, and watched the lights come on. Someone left a ledger on the doorstep with no note. Matthias has a suspect and is probably right. Kenji came by asking about the old tunnels. Matthias said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 11, autumn of year 31

the Ringmaster's troupe sent a notice about the harvest count. Matthias read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. At the big top, Matthias taught a newcomer how to tell a real coil of rope from a fake one by weight alone. Rumours about the harvest count reached the big top. Matthias pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. A stranger asked Matthias for the password to the workshop. Matthias laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.